

Historic Urban Landscape (HUL) scan

What this tool produces · *A comprehensive inventory defining the specific heritage attributes, community values, and socio-economic vulnerabilities of the urban landscape.*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Dimensions

Heritage

Spatial

Social / User

Preparing the workshop · *Historic Urban Landscape (HUL) scan*

G1 · Proof of Impact

Why this tool matters

Shifting the focus from isolated, frozen monuments to the living, breathing tissue of the city, recognizing that everyday human practices are just as valuable as ancient stones.

Evidence we produce

A comprehensive inventory defining the specific heritage attributes, community values, and socio-economic vulnerabilities of the urban landscape.

Duration & Material

Duration · 6 to 12 months for a complete urban scan

Material · HUL Guidebook toolkits, spatial mapping software, citizen workshop facilitation guides

Reference case

In Cuenca (Ecuador), the HUL approach was applied through a detailed scanning process involving 16 citizen workshops and multi-disciplinary mapping. By layering data on density, historical assets, and community rituals, the city identified distinct landscape units and drafted strategic development plans that protected both tangible buildings and intangible heritage like local markets,,.

Suggested agenda · Brief (10 min) > Method walk-through (15 min) > Animation canvas (60-90 min) > Harvest (20 min)

HUL · 6 dimensions of the urban heritage

Duration
6 to 12 months for a complete urban scan

Topography & geomorphology

natural form, ridge lines, watercourses

State

Trend

Threat

Built environment

fabric, density, typologies

State

Trend

Threat

Open spaces & gardens

parks, courtyards, plots

State

Trend

Threat

Land-use patterns

mix, density, intensity

State

Trend

Threat

Visual relationships

sight-lines, skyline, landmarks

State

Trend

Threat

Intangible & social

rituals, memories, identities

State

Trend

Threat

Harvesting our *learnings*

After running the canvas, capture three layers of insight.

What inspires me

Stand-out signals, surprising stories, ideas to remember

How to apply it here

Concrete adaptations to our context, our team, our constraints

What we need to be autonomous

Skills, allies, resources, decisions still to secure

Each participant fills a copy. Then debrief together to surface patterns and next steps.